TECHNICAL REPORT WRITING FOR CA#2 EXAMINATION

Enhancing Classification Model Performance using Cross-Validation Techniques

PAPER NAME: Human Resource development and Organizational Behaviour

PAPER CODE: OEC-IT601B

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UNIVERSITY ROLL NO.:18700123119

STREAM: COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

YEAR: 3rd

SEMESTER: 6th

SECTION: C

SESSION:2023-2027

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Abstract

This case study examines behavioural changes in an experienced employee following organizational restructuring in a manufacturing company. The reassignment of a senior plant head to a lower authority role led to reduced engagement, resistance to change, and declining coordination efficiency. The study identifies key antecedents such as perceived loss of authority, lack of inclusion in decision-making, and organizational injustice. It further evaluates the effectiveness of management's response, particularly the use of formal warnings, and its psychological impact on employee behaviour. The findings highlight that negative reinforcement without addressing emotional and professional concerns can worsen disengagement. A structured behaviour modification and reintegration plan is proposed, focusing on communication, role clarity, recognition, and participative leadership. The report concludes that aligning organizational change with employee expectations is crucial for maintaining productivity and morale.

Introduction

Organizational restructuring is often implemented to improve efficiency, competitiveness, and adaptability. However, such changes can significantly impact employee behaviour, especially when they involve shifts in authority, reporting structures, and leadership dynamics.

In the given case Case 6, a mid-sized automotive manufacturing company restructured its operations by integrating two production plants under centralized leadership. Mr. Arvind Rao, a long-serving Plant Head, was reassigned to a subordinate role under a newly appointed Vice President. Despite his past success and strong influence, his behaviour changed notably after the restructuring.

The organization began experiencing increased delays, absenteeism, and operational inefficiencies. Arvind's passive resistance, reduced engagement, and subtle non-compliance reflected deeper psychological and organizational issues.

This report aims to analyze the root causes of this behavioural shift, evaluate management's response, and examine how perceived injustice and status loss influenced employee performance. Furthermore, it proposes practical recommendations to restore organizational harmony and productivity.

Understanding such behavioural dynamics is essential for effective human resource management, especially in times of change.

Analysis

1.1 Problem Identification

The core problem is **behavioural disengagement due to restructuring**.

Key issues:

- Loss of authority and role downgrade
- Resistance to new systems
- Reduced motivation and engagement
- Informal resistance by loyal subordinates

1.2 Antecedents of Behavioural Change

The behavioural change in Arvind was triggered by:

1. Status Loss

- From Plant Head → Coordinator role
- Loss of power, influence, and identity

2. Perceived Organizational Injustice

- External VP hired instead of internal promotion
- Lack of recognition of past contributions

3. Lack of Participation

- No involvement in restructuring decisions
- Feeling of exclusion

4. Cultural Conflict

- Traditional vs modern digital systems

1.3 Impact on Organizational Performance

The behavioural shift negatively affected:

- **Coordination Efficiency:** Increased delays
- **Employee Morale:** Rise in absenteeism (12%)
- **Productivity:** Decline in performance
- **Compliance:** Irregular maintenance records

This shows how **one influential leader's disengagement can affect the entire system**.

1.4 Evaluation of Management Response

The VP used **formal warning (punishment approach)**.

Why it failed:

- Ignored emotional and psychological factors
- Increased resistance instead of correcting behaviour
- Created fear, not motivation

This is **counterproductive negative reinforcement**, not effective punishment.

1.5 Role of Perceived Injustice and Status Loss

Perceived Injustice

- Employees believed restructuring was unfair
- Reduced trust in management

Status Loss

- Arvind's identity and self-worth were affected
- Led to passive resistance

Result:

- Silent non-cooperation
- Reduced initiative
- Loyalty shift among employees

1.6 Behaviour Modification & Reintegration Plan

1. Role Redesign

- Give Arvind meaningful authority
- Define clear responsibilities

2. Participative Leadership

- Involve him in decision-making
- Encourage feedback

3. Recognition & Respect

- Acknowledge his experience publicly
- Restore professional dignity

4. Training & Adaptation

- Provide support for new systems
- Reduce resistance to digital tools

5. Communication Strategy

- Transparent communication about restructuring
- Address employee concerns

6. Positive Reinforcement

- Reward cooperation and improvement
- Avoid punitive approach

Conclusion

The case highlights the critical role of human behaviour in organizational success, particularly during periods of change. While restructuring aims to improve efficiency, it can unintentionally create psychological stress, dissatisfaction, and resistance among employees if not managed properly.

In this situation, the reassignment of a senior employee led to perceived injustice, status loss, and disengagement. These factors collectively contributed to declining organizational performance, increased absenteeism, and reduced coordination. The management's reliance on formal warnings failed to address the root causes and instead intensified resistance.

The analysis clearly shows that employee behaviour is deeply influenced by recognition, authority, and fairness. Ignoring these elements can lead to passive resistance, which is often more harmful than direct conflict.

To resolve such issues, organizations must adopt a more human-centric approach. Strategies such as participative leadership, role clarity, positive reinforcement, and transparent communication are essential for rebuilding trust and motivation.

In conclusion, effective organizational change is not just about structural adjustments but also about managing employee emotions, expectations, and perceptions. A balanced approach that integrates both operational efficiency and human resource sensitivity is key to long-term success.

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